Admissions policy

Policy statement

Bow Valley College admits applicants to Ministry-approved Bow Valley College programs on a fair and equitable basis in accordance with published admission requirements which optimize access and learner success.

Purpose

This policy promotes a consistent and fair admissions practice by establishing clear admissions criteria and procedures for credit programs which form the minimum academic, non-academic, and English language skills required to be successful in their program of study.
It also guides the admissions activity of the college to be consistent with its mission, mandate and values and aligns the admissions with the Academic Plan, Enrolment Plan and Strategic Enrolment Management.

Scope

This policy applies to all domestic and international applicants seeking admission to Bow Valley College post-secondary credit programs, Foundational Learning Upgrading and English Language Learning programs and courses regardless of learning location or delivery mode (e.g. in class, online, etc.). The admissions criteria approved pursuant to this policy may not apply to client-contracted or non-credit programs.

Principal objectives

1. The college establishes admissions criteria for all College Ministry-approved programs.
2. Admission criteria are applied fairly and equitably.
3. The college generally admits applicants on a first qualified, first accepted basis, reflecting its commitment to adult access to education. However, the College maintains the right to use a competitive selection process in particular circumstances related to the reputation of the college or a program area or the management of high demand programs.
4. The college establishes admission processes that ensure that domestic applicants have access to programs as appropriate to the government's funding of the college. It takes reasonable measures to prevent international learners from taking government-funded seats where there are domestic applicants who are qualified that have not been admitted. The college also supports access to college programming by international applicants that reflects their financial contribution to college programming, aligns with government immigration strategies, and advances college diversity and cross-cultural competence goals.
5. The college is committed to facilitating access to its programs for Indigenous peoples.

Compliance

Members of the college community are expected to adhere to the policies, procedures, and standards established by the college. These policies are designed to foster a safe, respectful, and inclusive environment that supports learning, teaching, and professional integrity.

Non-compliance may create risk for the college and will be addressed accordingly through applicable college policies, procedures and contracts. This may result in disciplinary action, up to and including expulsion for students.

Classification: General

Definitions

Admissions criteria:
Required qualifications for the selection of learners for entry into a particular program.

Applicant:
A person applying for admission to enroll in a Post-Secondary, Foundational Learning Upgrading or English Language Learning program.

Domestic applicant:
An applicant who is a citizen, landed immigrant/refugee, or permanent resident of Canada.

International applicant:
An applicant who is not a citizen, landed immigrant/refugee, or permanent resident of Canada.

Classification: General

Data sheet

Accountable officer
The Executive Team member responsible for the Office of the Registrar and Enrolment Services

Responsible officer
Director, Enrolment Management & Registrar

Contact area
Questions regarding this policy should be addressed to the Responsible Officer.

Relevant dates

Approved	Board of Governors: BOG171101-08
Effective	November 1, 2017
Next review	January 2028
Modification history	• Accountable and Responsible Officer updated 4-21-2023 • Rebranded 2021
Verified by	Office of the President, April 2023*

Associated policies
500-1-1: Learner Code of Conduct
500-1-4: Learner Accommodation Policy
500-1-5: Academic Continuance and Graduation Policy
500-1-6: Grading Policy
500-1-7: Academic Honesty
500-1-8: Prior Learning Assessment and Recognition Policy
500-1-9: Transfer Credit Policy
500-1-11: Learner Financial Accounts Policy
500-1-12: Learner Appeals Policy
500-1-18: Open Studies Policy
500-2-2: Academic Program Development and Change Policy

Directly related procedure
Admissions Policy Procedures

Related legislation
Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (FOIP)
Post-Secondary Learning Act (PSLA)

Classification: General